

The Intelligence Cycle

What threat intelligence is

Not "a threat feed." Intelligence is processed, assessed, actionable information for a *specific* decision. Feeds are raw material; the cycle produces a judgment.

The cycle

Direction (what decisions/products?)

- > Collection (feeds, OSINT, internal telemetry)
- > Processing (sanitize, enrich, de-dupe)
- > Analysis (context, TTPs, confidence, behavior)
- > Dissemination (product shaped for the consumer)
- > Feedback (did it help? adjust direction)

Key phrases

Raw / processed info – data before/after the human + tool enrichment

Analyst judgment – 'likely state-backed activity' with confidence level

Finish – how 'readiness-to-decide' the product is (finished = assessed)

Intelligence types by consumer

Type	Consumer	Product shape
Strategic	CEO / board	'threat landscape for our industry', no operations
Operational	SOC/IR leads	'who to expect next' + TTPs + recommendations

Type	Consumer	Product shape
Tactical	Analysts/detection engineers	Indicators: IOCs, signatures, hunting leads
Technical	Engineers	CVEs, exploits, patch roadmap

Pitfalls

Pile of feeds $\neq$ intelligence

'Attribution confidence' without evidence = noise

Product shaped for the wrong consumer (a board doesn't want a pcap)

No feedback loop – you never learn the product mattered

Your own mini-cycle

Direction: my org's risk is ransomware via VPNs.

Collection: feeds (URLhaus, Feodo), OSINT, SIEM hits.

Analysis: distinct IOCs overlap known ransomware-C2 patterns $\rightarrow$ adjudged high-confidence.

Dissemination: one-page monthly 'ransomware read-out'.

Feedback: ask SOC: was it actionable?

A threat-intel team's output is judged by whether a decision got better. Everything else is subscription content.

[← Module start](#)

[IOCs, IOAs & TTPs →](#)